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'Broadview Six' case in rare waters

Defense says US attorney may have had 'personal contact' with grand jury

By Jason Meisner
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

An attorney for the "Broadview Six" protesters told a federal judge Tuesday he has "reason to believe" that U.S. Attorney Andrew Boutros had personal contact with the grand jury and asked federal prosecutors to preserve any communications

about the case.

The comment in open court by attorney Christopher Parente, who represents Oak Park Trustee Brian Straw, was not expounded upon, and further discussion of the matter was done in the judge's chambers. Parente said that if such contact by Boutros did occur, they believe it should be disclosed.

Hours later, the U.S. attorney's office issued a written statement saying that since returning in April 2025 to become the district's top prosecutor, Boutros "has not appeared before any grand jury on any particular case."

"Any appearance he has made in the grand juries has been in his capacity as the Chief Legal Advisor to the federal grand juries of this district, including to welcome them when they were impaneled or to advise generally on the role, function, and importance of the grand

jury in our constitutional system of government and laws," the statement read.

More details could be learned Wednesday, when the defense is scheduled to file a motion further explaining requests to preserve evidence in the case.

The latest developments came five days after the Broadview Six case collapsed in dramatic fashion, with U.S. District Judge April Perry describing "shocking" misconduct before the grand jury and Boutros himself appearing in court to apol-

ogize and dismiss the charges on the eve of trial.

Boutros told Perry last week that he had only learned of the issues before the grand jury in late April, and moved immediately to dismiss the felony indictment and proceed on misdemeanor counts.

Defense attorneys have since asked Perry for an order requiring the U.S. attorney's office to preserve all emails, text messages and other communications regarding the case

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Visitors walk through St. Peter's Square at the Vatican on Tuesday. Mayor Brandon Johnson is scheduled to meet with Pope Leo XIV later in the week. **ARMANDO L. SANCHEZ/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

They'll come bearing Chicago-themed gifts

White Sox merch, giardiniera among items city leaders will deliver to Leo this week

By Alice Yin
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

ROME — A White Sox-emblazoned kippah. A Chicago sanctuary city pin. Bottled giardiniera. But not a Cubs hat.

Those are some of the several personal items Chicago leaders have said they will hand-deliver to Pope Leo XIV on Thursday, when Mayor Brandon Johnson will lead a delegation to the Vatican in his biggest international trip so far.

The full group has not yet been revealed by Johnson's team, but his communications director Erin Connelly did confirm that giardiniera from the renowned Italian market J.P. Graziano will be making an appearance among the many Chicago-themed gifts the Chicago-born pope will receive.

Connelly also said the mayor, who is a Chicago Cubs fan, will not be gifting Leo a hat with the insignia of the North Side team after talking about doing so in the

run-up to the trip, saying that was a "joke." But the city's sports team will be representing, she said, and she expects the mayor will touch on baseball stats with the White Sox-cheering pontiff.

Johnson plans to focus his one-on-one with Leo on the pope's sweeping encyclical released Monday that condemned the Holy See's role in legitimizing slavery, while cautioning the public that today's reliance on artificial intelligence could spell a new

form of colonialism.

The historic apology is a natural fit for the progressive mayor and son of a pastor, who often leans into themes of racial justice in his rhetoric.

Connelly also nodded to the latest attack on Johnson from President Donald Trump — who has also criticized Leo — and suggested that his antagonism might come up.

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Hawthorne alleges it's losing out on state funds

Race course says top Illinois official steered money to rival track

By Jeremy Gorner
and Robert McCoppin
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

SPRINGFIELD — About three months after filing for bankruptcy, representatives for Hawthorne Race Course are alleging they are losing out on state funding because a top official in Gov. JB Pritzker's administration — with the influence of his brother, a lobbyist — has been steering money to a rival racetrack, according to court papers filed last week.

On Tuesday, lobbyist John Costello, the brother of Illinois Department of Agriculture Director Jerry Costello, called the allegations "defamatory" in a prepared statement.

The explosive accusations are the latest chapter in a saga in which Hawthorne, a 135-year-old institution in Stickney just outside Chicago, is trying to restructure its debt and save dozens of jobs while working to rescue the state's dying horse racing industry. A lawyer for Hawthorne and its creditors is scheduled to appear Wednesday before a federal bankruptcy court judge to discuss the latest filing, as the racetrack operator seeks permission to acquire additional records in the case.

The May 20 filing states that Hawthorne, as one of Illinois' oldest and largest horse racing facilities, is conducting a sale of its facility and that it has received a crucial source of operating funds through the state's so-called Thoroughbred Fund, controlled by the agriculture department director. Hawthorne, which has historically received 55% to 60% of the fund's money because it holds significantly more races than its lone competitor, Fairmount Park in downstate Collinsville, said that pattern has shifted since it filed for bankruptcy in February, the

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INSIDE

ICE releases CPS senior after hearing

Ricardo Hernández-Navarrete is coming home. The CPS senior who was arrested by ICE agents at a routine check-in in March was released Tuesday after a bond hearing in immigration court. **Chicagoland, Page 4**

Sox duo feeling right at home



Japanese speedster Rikuu Nishida and slugger Munetaka Murakami are making themselves comfortable with the White Sox, writes Paul Sullivan. **Sports**



TERRENCE ANTONIO JAMES/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Critic's Choice Food Awards

Jesús Quiahua plates orders at the restaurant M'daKhan in Bridgeview on May 21. M'daKhan is among the winners in the Critic's Choice Food Awards. This year's winners represent the best of us with deliciousness and daring and hope. **Food & Health**

Trump's plans to reshape maps dealt dual setbacks

Senate rejects call to redistrict in SC; court halts bid in Alabama

By Meg Kinnard, Jeffrey Collins, Kim Chandler
and David A. Lieb
ASSOCIATED PRESS

COLUMBIA, S.C. — President Donald Trump's push to reshape congressional districts ahead of the November elections suffered a double setback Tuesday, as South Carolina senators declined to do so and a federal court blocked a Republican-backed map in Alabama.

As early in-person voting began Tuesday in South Carolina's primaries, the state Senate rejected a Republican plan to cancel those congressional votes

and instead schedule a new primary under revised districts designed to help the GOP oust a longtime Democrat.

Some senators said it was too late to make a change.

"South Carolina citizens are going to the polls today. And neither my conscience or common sense is going to let me stop an election that is already underway," GOP state Sen. Richard Cash said.

The political drama in South Carolina is part of a Republican strategy — propelled by Trump — to redraw voting districts to the GOP's advantage in an attempt to hold on to a slim House majority in the midterm elections. Republicans have been moving quickly to try to leverage a recent U.S. Supreme Court ruling that weak-

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